SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | PROTEIN-RICH ITALIAN MEALS

Pesce all’Acqua Pazza: 20-Minute Neapolitan Poached Fish in ’Crazy Water’ (34g Protein)

PREP: 5 mins | COOK: 15 mins | TOTAL: 20 mins | SERVINGS: 4 servings | CALORIES: 340 kcal

INGREDIENTS

* 4 fillets (170g / 6 oz each) Firm White Fish (Cod, Halibut, Branzino, or Snapper) (patted dry and seasoned with sea salt)
* 350g (2 cups) Ripe Cherry Tomatoes (halved)
* 3 tbsp (45ml) Extra-Virgin Olive Oil (plus extra for drizzling)
* 4 cloves Fresh Garlic (thinly sliced)
* 2 tbsp Non-Pareil Capers (or Gaeta Olives) (rinsed)
* 1/2 tsp Crushed Red Pepper Flakes (or 1 Calabrian Chili)
* 120ml (1/2 cup) Dry White Wine (Falanghina, Vermentino, or Pinot Grigio)
* 120ml (1/2 cup) Warm Water or Seafood Stock
* 1 bunch Fresh Flat-Leaf Parsley (stems tied together for simmering, leaves chopped for garnish)
* 4 thick slices Crusty Country Bread (toasted and rubbed with garlic for serving)

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Infuse Garlic, Chili & Parsley Stems in Olive Oil (2 mins)

Warm 3 tablespoons of extra-virgin olive oil in a wide 12-inch skillet over medium heat. Add the sliced garlic, red pepper flakes, capers, and whole parsley stems, cooking for 90 seconds until the garlic is pale golden and fragrant.

Step 2: Blister the Cherry Tomatoes & Build the Crazy Water (6 mins)

Add the halved cherry tomatoes with a pinch of sea salt and saut for 3 minutes until they soften and blister. Pour in the dry white wine and warm water, bring to a lively simmer for 3 minutes, and press a few tomatoes gently with a wooden spoon to release their ruby juices.

Step 3: Nestle & Poach the Fish Fillets Under a Lid (7 mins)

Discard the parsley stems. Nestle the seasoned white fish fillets into the simmering broth. Spoon some of the tomatoes and broth over the top, cover the skillet with a tight lid, reduce heat to medium-low, and poach gently for 6-8 minutes (depending on thickness) until the fish flakes easily.

Step 4: Emulsify the Broth with Fresh Parsley & Olive Oil (2 mins)

Transfer the poached fillets onto 4 warmed shallow bowls alongside a slice of garlic-rubbed country toast. Turn the skillet heat to high for 60 seconds, stir in the chopped fresh parsley leaves and 1 tablespoon of raw extra-virgin olive oil to emulsify the broth, and spoon generously over the fish.

NONNA’S CHEF TIPS:

- Keep the poaching liquid at a gentle bubble rather than a violent boil once the fish goes in so the fillets stay silky and intact.
- Simmering the whole parsley stems in Step 1 and 2 infuses twice as much herbal flavor into the broth without wilting your fresh leaf garnish.